AUTHORIZATION MEMORANDUM

Harborview Securities LLC - Leveraged Finance and Acquisition Finance

Date: 10 February 2026

Re: Project Kestrel - authorization to engage as financial advisor and to pursue a potential acquisition-financing role

1. Purpose

This memorandum records the internal authorization to (a) execute the engagement letter appointing Harborview Securities LLC as exclusive financial advisor to the Sponsor in connection with Project Kestrel, and (b) proceed with preliminary internal work assessing whether a Harborview affiliate may separately act as arranger and/or lender in the acquisition financing, subject to that affiliate's own credit approval under the Internal Credit Policy.

This memorandum authorizes the advisory engagement now. It does not itself constitute credit approval of any financing exposure. Any financing commitment requires a separate credit approval under Article II of the Internal Credit Policy, obtained before any commitment letter is issued.

2. Exposure being authorized

The exposure authorized by this memorandum is the advisory engagement itself: Harborview's exposure to its own fee receivable and to the reputational and conflicts considerations described in the engagement letter. No leveraged finance credit exposure is authorized by this memorandum.

Should the deal team pursue a financing role for a Harborview affiliate, that affiliate's pro forma total net leverage exposure to the obligor will need separate authorization once the exposure is capable of being sized, which is not the case at the date of this memorandum. The deal team is directed to size that exposure only once confirmatory diligence, including the quality-of-earnings review and the Consolidated EBITDA build, is far enough advanced to support a reliable calculation.

3. Credit policy provisions relied on

Article I, Section 1.01 of the Internal Credit Policy brings within the Policy's scope every exposure arising from a change of control of an obligor, irrespective of leverage. Project Kestrel is a change-of-control transaction, so any financing role a Harborview affiliate later takes falls within the Policy's scope regardless of where the resulting pro forma leverage lands.

Article II, Section 2.02 states the Policy's hard gate: no exposure may be approved where pro forma total net leverage, measured at closing, exceeds 5.50x Consolidated EBITDA. Section 2.04 separately requires a documented rating-sensitivity assessment wherever pro forma leverage exceeds 4.80x, whether or not the Section 2.02 gate itself is at risk.

Section 2.03 is noted for completeness: the 5.25x maintenance covenant level in the obligor's own credit agreement is a contractual test between the obligor and its lenders. It is not this firm's internal limit and the deal team is directed not to treat covenant headroom as a proxy for Policy compliance.

Article VI governs any exception to the Article II limits: an exception requires the affirmative vote of the Credit Risk Committee and the written concurrence of the Chief Risk Officer, is specific to the exposure for which it is granted, and does not extend to any other exposure, tranche or amendment.

4. Approver

Approved by the Head of Leveraged Finance, acting under delegated authority to authorize an advisory engagement that carries no financing exposure at the date of authorization. Authorization of any subsequent financing exposure remains subject to Article II and, if applicable, Article VI, and is not delegated by this memorandum.

5. Conditions attached

First, the engagement letter's conflicts-of-interest provisions, including the information barrier between advisory and credit personnel described there, must be operative before any advisory work involving non-public information from the financing side begins.

Second, the deal team shall not represent to the Sponsor, the Company or any third party that financing

is available or committed until a definitive financing commitment has been separately authorized under Article II.

Third, if the deal team later seeks financing-role authorization, the credit memorandum supporting that request shall address each item Article V of the Internal Credit Policy requires: the pro forma leverage calculation with its inputs, the Consolidated EBITDA build showing each addback and cap applied, the net debt build identifying the definition used, and the change-of-control analysis required by Article IV.

Fourth, this authorization does not extend to any transaction other than Project Kestrel as presently contemplated, and lapses if the Transaction structure changes materially before a financing role is authorized.

6. Basis for proceeding now

The deal team has represented that preliminary review of the Company's public disclosure and its outstanding senior unsecured notes did not identify a reason the Transaction could not, in principle, be structured within the Policy's Article II limits, subject to confirmatory diligence. That representation supports proceeding with the advisory engagement; it is not itself a leverage calculation and must not be cited as one in any later credit memorandum.

The Committee Secretary shall record this memorandum's date against the effective-date field of the Internal Credit Policy edition then in force, so that any later reader comparing this memorandum against a superseded interim committee memorandum can determine which document is the properly authorized, governing one, per Internal Credit Policy Section 7.03.

7. Diligence record relied on at the date of this memorandum

At the date of this memorandum the diligence record consists principally of publicly available information about the Company and its outstanding senior unsecured notes, together with the Sponsor's own preliminary screening analysis. No non-public financial information has been received from the Company. No quality-of-earnings engagement has yet commenced.

The deal team's preliminary screening did not identify a public disclosure suggesting the Company carries indebtedness inconsistent, on its face, with a leveraged acquisition of this general size and sector. That observation is offered as context only; it is not a substitute for the credit-agreement-based leverage build Article III requires and must not be cited as one.

The deal team is directed to obtain and reconcile the following before any financing-role authorization request is submitted: the Company's most recent audited financial statements and their notes; a quality-of-earnings report addressing the Consolidated EBITDA build and its addbacks; the Company's own credit agreement, if refinanced or assumed, or the acquisition financing's credit agreement, if newly arranged, including its addback caps and baskets; and confirmation of whether the Company's outstanding notes carry a change-of-control repurchase provision and, if so, on what terms.

8. Distribution and record-keeping

This memorandum is distributed to the deal team, the Head of Leveraged Finance, and the Committee Secretary for filing in the Project Kestrel matter record. It supersedes no prior memorandum, because none exists for this matter as of its date, and it is not itself superseded by any future memorandum unless that later memorandum expressly says so and is issued by a person with authority to do so.

A copy of the executed engagement letter shall be attached to the filed copy of this memorandum. Any subsequent financing-role credit memorandum shall cross-reference this memorandum by date rather than restate the scope authorized here.